

CEO

Cameron Ellis

CEO · ACADEMIC

HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Commit: Play a card by paying Surplus instead of Leverage, at its normal timing.

Created the game.

Hentges Fellow of Finance and Associate Professor at the University of Iowa. Fellow of the Vaughan Institute of Risk Management.

cellis212.github.io

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 165 / 348

OFFICE LOCATION

Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 330 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 348

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 348

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 348

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 348

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 348

INVESTMENT

Corn Farms

INVESTMENT

COST

2

YIELD

1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

Yield +1 while you have an office in Des Moines.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Planted in April, priced in Chicago, and paid for by the weather.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 104 / 348

INVESTMENT

Corn Farms

INVESTMENT

COST

2

YIELD

1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

Yield +1 while you have an office in Des Moines.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Planted in April, priced in Chicago, and paid for by the weather.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 104 / 348

INVESTMENT

Soy Farms

INVESTMENT



COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

Crop rotation. Yield +1 while this is paired with a Corn Farms you control, one to one.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Corn one year and soybeans the next, because the nitrogen comes free even if the price doesn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 105 / 348

INVESTMENT

Soy Farms

INVESTMENT



COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

Crop rotation. Yield +1 while this is paired with a Corn Farms you control, one to one.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Corn one year and soybeans the next, because the nitrogen comes free even if the price doesn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 105 / 348

INVESTMENT

Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST	YIELD
◆ 3	● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Inflation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Liquidity Crunch, Bank Run, or Global Recession hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 071 / 348

INVESTMENT

Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST	YIELD
◆ 3	● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Inflation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Liquidity Crunch, Bank Run, or Global Recession hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 071 / 348

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST	YIELD
◆ 3	

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 052 / 348

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST	YIELD
◆ 3	

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 052 / 348

PROGRAM

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE



COST	YIELD
◆ 4	

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. The runner cannot pay to push it through. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 161 / 348

PROGRAM

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE



COST	YIELD
◆ 4	

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. The runner cannot pay to push it through. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 161 / 348

PROGRAM

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE



COST	YIELD
◆ 4	

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. The runner cannot pay to push it through. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 161 / 348

PROGRAM

Crisis Communications

RESPONSE



COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Reputation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 2 more Leverage.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said the statement drafted in advance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 125 / 348

PROGRAM

Crisis Communications

RESPONSE



COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Reputation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 2 more Leverage.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said the statement drafted in advance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 125 / 348

SIGNATURE PROGRAM

Industry Lobbying

RESPONSE



COST
◆ 2

SIGNATURE RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 3 more Leverage.

The trade association would like to submit four hundred pages of comments.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 124 / 348

PROGRAM

Incident Response Retainer

RESPONSE



COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Cyber Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 2 more Leverage.

The forensics team is on a plane before the ransom note finishes loading.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 126 / 348

SIGNATURE PROGRAM

Everything Is Fine

RESPONSE



COST
◆ 1

DARK SIGNATURE RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Liquidity or Reputation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 3 more Leverage.

The chairman was calm, confident, and on live television. Two of those were true.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 145 / 348

TALENT

Executive Assistant

FRONT LINE



HIRE
◆ 2

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

Found an opening in your calendar and put you in it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 164 / 348

TALENT

Executive Assistant

FRONT LINE



HIRE
◆ 2

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

Found an opening in your calendar and put you in it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 164 / 348

TALENT

Corporate Spy

FRONT LINE



HIRE
◆ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent's maximum hand size is 1 lower.

Badge says Facilities, laptop says otherwise.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 206 / 348

TALENT

Risk Management Professor

ACADEMIC



HIRE
◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for a Program, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

Wrote the textbook your CRO still keeps on the desk.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 203 / 348

TOOL

Delegation Dashboard

SOFTWARE

PRICE
◆ 3

▲ Cyber

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

That meeting could have been somebody else's meeting.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 335 / 348

SIGNATURE TOOL

Generative AI Pilot

SOFTWARE

PRICE
◆ 2

CARRYING COST
● 1 each turn

SIGNATURE AI

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck; AI: AI Bubble Bursts destroys it.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Summarizes every report in the building, including three that don't exist.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 344 / 348

STRESS TEST

Liquidity Crunch

LIQUIDITY

COST
◆ 3

HITS
Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

Everyone wants cash, so nobody is bidding on your assets.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 260 / 348

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010

COST
◆ 3

HITS
Each opponent

SIGNATURE BREAKING ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Breaking: can also be run at the end of another player's turn; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Each opponent loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 274 / 348

STRESS TEST

Social Inflation Surge

LITIGATION

COST
◆ 4

HITS
Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Litigation

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 8 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Billboard lawyers, litigation funding, and juries that have seen the headlines.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 273 / 348

STRESS TEST

Whistleblower

CORPORATE

COST
◆ 2

HITS
Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 289 / 348